



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom of the will and determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

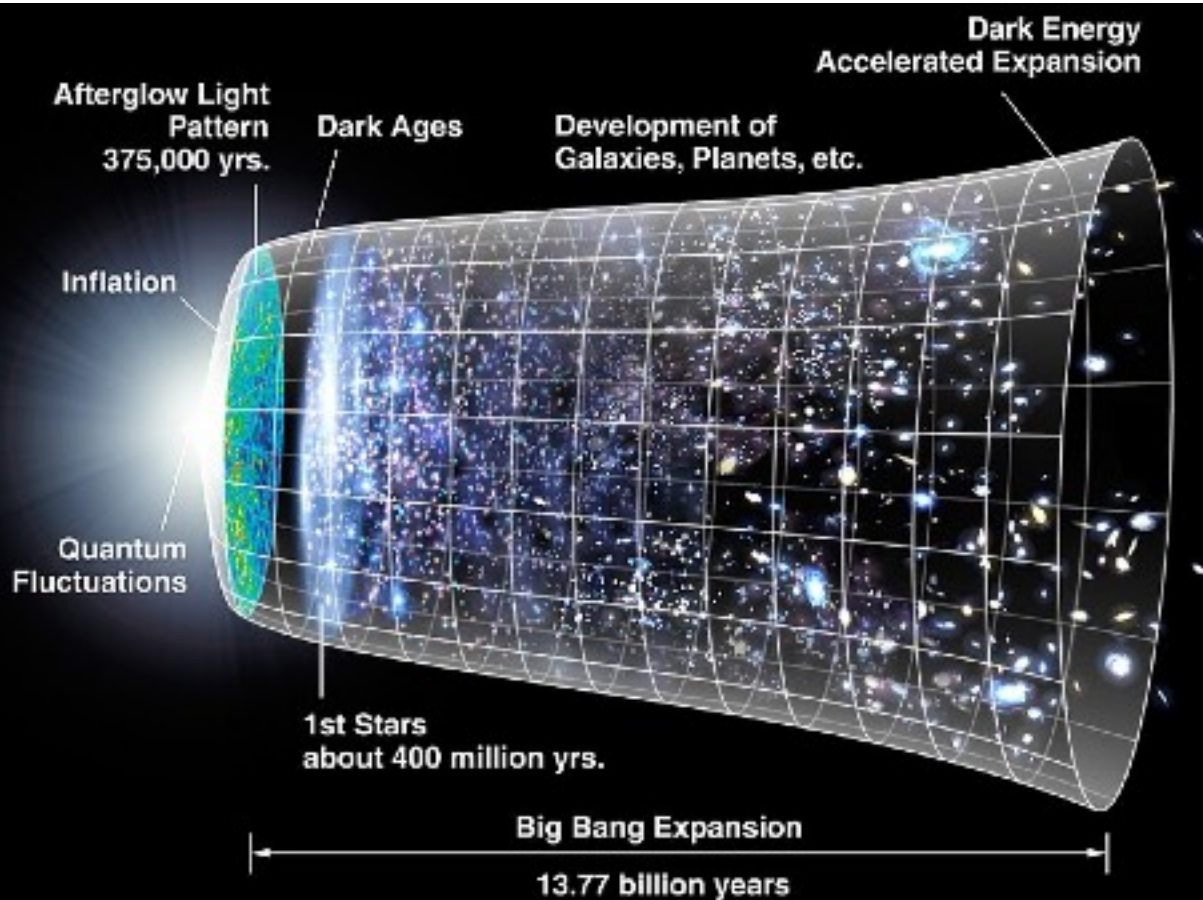
What is 'determinism'?

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

What determinism says is that, given a full specification of the state of the universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at every later time.

Our topic today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.

"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."



Sometimes people use 'determinism' as a name for the thesis that there is no free will, so that determinism rules out free will by definition. That is not how we are using the term. Determinism is a thesis about the laws of the nature. It is then an open question whether we could have free will in a world with deterministic laws.

Let's focus in on that question:

This gives us three possible views about freedom of the will.

The argument we are going to talk about today capitalizes on this fact.

The master argument against free will tries to show that both of the
left two boxes are false.

1. Either (i) Compatibilism is true or (ii) Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free will.
2. Compatibilism is false.
3. Libertarianism is false.

C. There is no free will.

THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL

Compatibilism

Freedom of the will is real, and compatible with determinism.

Libertarianism

Freedom of the will is real, and incompatible with determinism.

There is no free
will.

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Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

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universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at

every/after time.



ment is consistent with the law.

containing the state of things at a given

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1. Either (i) $\text{Compat}i b i 1 i n$ is true or $(i i)$

W i l l .

3:Libertarianism is false.

2. Input in list.

C. Their is no fire in will.



Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free











2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

varlatatie + the last of the

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

1. No one has any choice about events which

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

3. If determined, the only one

then DECISION happens. (3)

4. If determinism is true, the laws of



future is not just what the state of the

then DECISION. (4,5)

happened in the distant past.

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

and none has any choice about whether,

theorie about the fact that if DNR

of interest.

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

about whether @.

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any



6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

choice about the laws of nature, then no

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice principle, and determinism

rules out free will.

combination of four - that No

seem quite plausible, the argument

Since the first three of these theses

seems to show that if determinism is

hence that free will is incompatible with

dearminism.

true, there are no free actions — and





1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.



0: There is no fire in.



Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).



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against
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A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



Wili.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.

0. There is no fire in.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

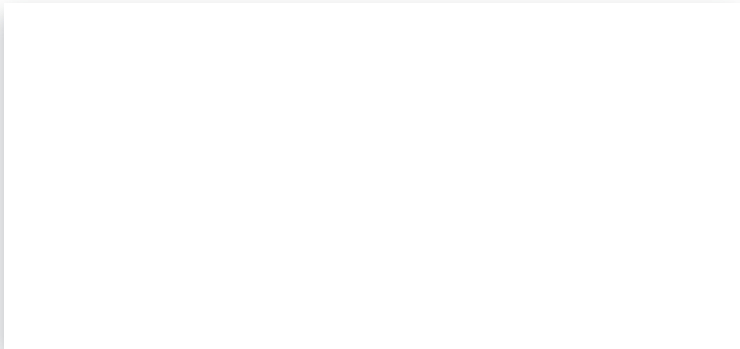
or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, serving as a background for the text.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

[REDACTED]

"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."



compatible with

dear friends?



The **incompatible** says 'No.' The **compatible** says 'Yes.'





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3:Libertarianism is false.

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CS: Theire is no fire will.

2. compatibilism is false.



W i l l .

THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL